Hursty's Four Pointer

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BDT 2008 · Lisbon · Featuring Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



The Monkey prior to the Four-Pointer!

This story is one that every tourist is familiar with. Even now, some Dogs breathe a small sigh of relief when they pass the four-point mark on any BDT round. I can do no better than let James explain his experience in his own words:



HURSTY

"Whilst the previous 7 tours that I have had the great pleasure of attending have provided so many cherished and humorous highlights, unfortunately they have also contained a number of lowlights.

When considering which was to be the lowest moment, a number of occasions sprang to mind including:

- changing the spikes on my golf shoes in Marbella on BDT 2002;
- losing third place to Boysie having missed a two foot putt on the last in La Manga;
- losing 5 & 4 to Langrish in 2005; and
- any one of seven vicious demon attacks at the end of each of the said tours.

However, one occasion stands head and shoulders above all others as my darkest hour/s on tour and it took place on Friday 16 May 2008 which would prove to be the day when I set a tour record that is likely to never be broken.

Arriving at Penha Longa Golf Club for Round II of the 2008 BDT I was already pretty schmokered after a few quick 'Hairs of The Dog' with Ravo at the gritty hotel Jack had booked us into. After announcing the 'Steve' pairings for the round on the bus, I thought it was a good idea to seek out another few light ales prior to embarking upon the round.

I had only managed 20 points the day before (my worst round on tour to that point) so thought I couldn't do much worse and a few Stella Miguels might help to settle a few nerves - I was wrong! As per usual, all the Bloodhounds refused a pre-match pint and I was left to finish off the lagers with Robbo and BT before making my way to the first tee with my head spinning in all directions! Note from the picture above that I also polished off the full one!

After successfully defeating our Bloodhound opponents the previous day, I was relieved that once again I would be partnered by Oli G as we took on The Little Dog and Langrish in the third match out.

On the tee - ChewHACKER! I thought that this tour nickname had been slightly harsh, but on this day it would prove to haunt me!!

Things didn't start too disastrously as I somehow managed to get one airborne off the first and ended up taking a scrambled double bogey 6 for 1 point.

Second tee - 4 iron, straight right, lost ball. Blob (this was to be repeated a number of times over the course of the next 4 hours).

After reaching the 6th hole with a mere one point to my name and struggling to see never mind hit the ball, I started to feel something or someone coming up behind me....yes the Demons had arrived and it was at this point that they started whispering in my ear (rather apt really) that the worst ever round on the BDT was Robbo's 9 pointer in 2003 and that I was in grave danger of beating it unless I pulled myself together. Come on Hursty, you're better than this!!!!

To my sheer relief I managed to connect with one off the 7th tee and scraped a bogey 5 for 2 points.

No need to panic, I was off and running now - wrong..... blobs at the 8th and 9th meant I reached the turn with a grand total of 3 points - GOOD! Safe to say that my opponents couldn't control their laughter whilst my partner's patience was starting to run thin as he single-handedly was keeping us in the match where we were remarkably still all square.

It was at this point as I dragged myself up the hill to the halfway hut that I started to regret the decision NOT to get a buggy and instead carry my bag around the 18 holes. As Little zoomed past me up the hill, the Demons were indescribable and I thought there was only one thing to do in an attempt to somehow battle my way to that magical 9 point figure which was my first and only target!!!

'2 Large beers please Barman'. It was simply the only way to banish the voices in my head and battle my way through the remaining 9 holes of torture. ERROR.

Filled with a new-found confidence I decided to kick off the back nine with my Big Dog which had only appeared twice previously in the round to disastrous effect. Thankfully, I made a good connection but unfortunately the ball veered slightly left into a clump of trees. After looking for my ball for c 15 minutes during which I nearly collapsed, I gave up and walked onto the 11th tee. Big Dog again, just about missed the out of bounds and scrambled my way to a double bogey 6 for my first point of the back nine.

Blobs at the 12th and 13th followed and it was at this point that the reality of the situation suddenly started to kick in and with that realisation the demons returned. I had 5 holes to play and needed to score 6 points to surpass Robbo's remarkable all time worst score!

Surely, surely, surely, I couldn't...could I?

On the 14th tee Little whispered to me 'Lad, if I were you I'd keep the Big Dog in the bag!' but I was determined to persevere and thought that by the law of averages, I just had to smoke one! Wrong - First ball, whack, snap hook, trees... second off the tee, nice slice onto Estoril Racetrack! Blob, move on.

A combination of my awful golf, the heat and my lack of buggy was seriously affecting my energy levels and I was starting to suffer. The Bloodhounds could see my strife and kindly offered me their buggy for the hole. To make matters worse I managed to get the buggy stuck on a steep incline and very nearly rolled the thing!

Onto the 15th - par 3 - Blob.

I now needed 6 points in 3 holes and couldn't figure out how the hell I was going to get them. 16th - Par 4 over trees...B*llocks, 2 lost balls off the tee, pick up and onto the next. At this point I had pretty much thrown in the towel, I hadn't scored a point since the 11th and hadn't putted since the 12th! All I wanted was for the round to end!

A nice easy 7 iron off the 17th tee ended up shanked into the trees and I very nearly walked into the clubhouse....but there was a serious match still to be played as we went down the last incredibly All Square.

It was on the 18th tee that Big Ols said to me 'Come on Hursty, it's not been your best round (what a f***ing understatement that was!) but one last effort and we could actually win this one'. 2 iron off the tee, connected and I was in play, CUMON!!! Unfortunately my next 6 shots weren't so good as I picked up before the green leaving Big Ols to sink the winning putt as he had done tirelessly all afternoon.

I shook hands with my playing companions and walked off the final green head in hand having registered a historic worst ever BDT round of 4 points, a highly embarrassing score that was by far the worst golfing experience of my 20 year career. For the record, I blobbed 15 of the 18 holes, only putted on 12 and managed 1 point on the last 11. Quite remarkable stats!

It was unquestionably my darkest and most disastrous day on tour and after having to wear the Shitzu shirt for the second consecutive night, there was only one thing to do!!"



Hursty drowns his sorrows